

Anasuya Narasimhan

📍 Berkeley, CA ✉ anarasimhan@berkeley.edu in Anasuya Narasimhan

Education

UC Berkeley

July 2025 – present

PhD in Agricultural and Resource Economics

- **Coursework:** First-year sequence in microeconomic theory, macroeconomic theory, and econometrics.
- **Tentative Fields:** Development, Labour, Behavioural Economics

University of Oxford

Sep 2022 – Jul 2023

MSc in Economics for Development

- **Grades:** Distinction (Top of the Cohort), received the **George Webb Medley Prize for Best Overall Performance in 2023..**
- **Coursework:** Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, International Trade, Quantitative Methods, Development Economics (specialised in Labour Economics, Behavioural Economics and Industrial Policy).
- **Thesis:** “Sparking Industrial Growth? Evidence on the Impact of Electrification on Industrial Outcomes in India”.[\(link\)](#) [🔗](#).

Durham University

Sept 2017 – Aug 2020

BA Philosophy, Politics and Economics

- **Grade:** First Class Honours; High distinction grade in dissertation (76) and Advanced Econometrics (82)
- **Courses:** Economic Methods (comprised of mathematical and statistical methods including Linear & Matrix algebra, Differential & Integral calculus, Probability, and Statistical Testing), Intermediate Microeconomics and Macroeconomics, and Advanced Econometrics.
- **Thesis:** “Gender, Socioeconomic Environment and Political Engagement: A study of Indian Elections in the 1990s and early 2000s”, using Difference-in-Difference Methodology.

Real Analysis via University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign’s NetMath

Jul 2024-Jan 2025

- **Grade:** A (4.0 GPA)

Experience

UC Berkeley Haas School of Business

September 2025 - Present

Graduate Student Researcher

- Contributing to research on mental health at the workplace With Ulrike Malmendier (Berkeley), Kate Orkin (Oxford), and Matthew Ridley (Warwick), with fieldwork in progress in Nairobi, Kenya.
- Key contributions include field team supervision, survey design on oTree, preliminary analysis, and Berkeley IRB liaising.

University of Oxford

Aug 2023 - Present

Predoctoral Research Assistant

- Working with Kate Orkin (Oxford), Ulrike Malmendier (Berkeley), and Matthew Ridley (Warwick) on a project studying mental health and labour market outcomes in Kenya (Fieldwork in Progress); and Kate Orkin, Rob Garlick (Duke), and Mahreen Mahmud (Exeter) on Aspiring to a Better Future: Can a Simple Psychological Intervention Reduce Poverty? (Forthcoming at REStud)
- Leading research management, analysis, and fieldwork for a new randomised control trial (RCT) on mental health and labour market outcomes in Kenya. Completed two month-long pilots in Nairobi, including design and end-to-end execution of a novel protocol for measuring productivity in a customer service task.
- Conduct analysis for concluded RCTs completed by the lab, this includes working collaboratively via GitHub on complex code packages on STATA and R.
- Conduct extensive literature reviews to inform project design, such as inputs to task variations to capture different behavioural responses to anxiety and to intervention protocols for scale-up of Active Labour Market

Policy (ALMP) interventions.

- Lead the relationship with regional partner, including designing scope of work and contract, monitoring implementation, and overseeing budgets.

Deputy Chief Minister's Office, Government of NCT. Of Delhi
Program Associate

Sep 2020 - Aug 2022

- Drafted concept note for India's first specialised schooling system backed by extensive research on global models and stakeholder consultations. Approved by Delhi Government's Cabinet in March 2021.
- Designed and executed the strategy for India's first Performing and Visual Arts (PVA) specialised schools.
- Created long-term roadmap for schools: scale-up plan, target outcomes, and resource & budget requirements.
- Onboarded and managed 3 partner higher education institutions to develop and implement curriculum.
- Established 20 schools in 2021, which was scaled up to 30 in 2022 by the state, catering to over 6000 students.
- Improved data collection mechanisms to obtain consistent data on oxygen use and bed occupancy from hospitals during the second wave of Covid-19 in New Delhi.
- Set-up a single-platform dashboard with Covid-19 statistics in collaboration with technology partners.
- Set up the Integrated Control and Command Centre (ICCC) to boost operational efficiency and passenger safety in the city of Delhi's fleet of over 7000 buses through a CCTV and panic alarm system, and GPS vehicle tracking. The buses cater to 3 million people daily.
- Identified KPIs for the bus system and created a first version dashboard with technology partners that was approved for full scale development by the state.
- Identified gaps in the GPS data stream transmitted by devices in Delhi's buses; improved success by 300%.

Conference Presentations

"Sparking Industrial Growth? Evidence on the Impact of Electrification on Industrial Outcomes in India"
Centre for Study of African Economies (CSAE) Annual Conference 2025.

Skills

Languages: English (native), Hindi (advanced), Tamil (proficient)

Technologies: STATA, R, Python, QGIS, LaTeX

Personal

In another life, I trained as a singer and dabbled with the guitar and piano.

I also spent several weekends at University debate competitions.

You can find some of my more sporadic writing on <https://basicbananaa.wordpress.com/> 